

COMBAT MINDSET — THE WAY FORWARD

Defining, developing and assuring the human-performance capability Army requires to remain effective in combat.

WARFIGHTING IMPERATIVE

REMAIN EFFECTIVE. **ACT DECISIVELY.**

Army requires individuals, teams and leaders who remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat.



COMBAT MINDSET

Combat-specific expression

▼ enabled by



PERFORMANCE UNDER PRESSURE

Enabling human-performance capability

▼ developed and organised through



ARMY COMBAT MINDSET FRAMEWORK

Organising model

▼ delivered through

Combat Mindset is the individual and collective readiness and disposition to remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat in order to achieve the mission.

It is the combat-specific expression of Performance Under Pressure.

Performance Under Pressure is the trainable individual and collective human-performance capability to:

- ✓ Prepare for pressure
- ✓ Adapt within pressure
- ✓ Maintain performance through pressure
- ✓ Recover from pressure

Applicable across combat, command, crisis response, training, garrison leadership and high-risk technical activity.

The Army Combat Mindset Framework is the organising model through which Army defines, develops, integrates and assures the capabilities, products and governance arrangements that enable Combat Mindset.

It organises:

- Doctrinal definitions
- Developmental progression
- Governance
- Desired outcomes
- Products and methods
- Evidence
- Provisional pillars
- Delivery responsibilities
- Assurance

PROVISIONAL CAPABILITY PILLARS

Provisional working pillars — subject to Phase 1 validation



Leadership



Self-regulation



Performance cognition



Resilience & recovery



Physical performance



Identity, values & will



Collective performance

▼ each product contributes across multiple pillars

TRAINING PRODUCTS AND METHODS

NZALC
Performance Under Pressure package

NZDF Psychology products

COGCON
Developmental performance-cognition product

Scenario, experiential & progressive pressure training

Physical & cognitive conditioning

Structured reflection & recovery

Other products identified in Phase 1 stocktake

Dashed outline indicates developmental status pending the Phase 1 stocktake

Developed across the Prepare – Perform – Recover cycle · Lead Self ▶ Lead Teams ▶ Lead Leaders ▶ Lead Systems

Delivered by approved training establishments, units and existing instructor workforces across Army



GOVERNANCE AND ASSURANCE

- Army Sponsor — strategic sponsorship and policy direction
- COMDT ACS — interim capability integrator
- ACS — framework development and capability-integration lead
- HPC — COGCON product steward; performance-cognition adviser
- Layered doctrine, evidence, professional and delivery assurance



PROGRAMME OF WORK — PHASES 0–4

0. Define terms, sponsorship and relationship
1. Stocktake current capabilities, products and evidence
2. Draft the Army Combat Mindset Framework
3. Validate with stakeholders and units
4. Report back — Framework v1.0, November 2026



HARDER TO KILL

Proposed Warfighter Focus tagline — subject to sponsor endorsement